

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 23, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 45:1-8

1 Moreover, when you divide the land by lot into inheritance, you shall set apart a district for the Lord, a holy section of the land; its length shall be twenty-five thousand cubits, and the width ten thousand. It shall be holy throughout its territory all around.

2 Of this there shall be a square plot for the sanctuary, five hundred by five hundred rods, with fifty cubits around it for an open space.

3 So this is the district you shall measure: twenty-five thousand cubits long and ten thousand wide; in it shall be the sanctuary, the Most Holy Place.

4 It shall be a holy section of the land, belonging to the priests, the ministers of the sanctuary, who come near to minister to the Lord; it shall be a place for their houses and a holy place for the sanctuary.

5 An area twenty-five thousand cubits long and ten thousand wide shall belong to the Levites, the ministers of the temple; they shall have twenty chambers as a possession.

6 You shall appoint as the property of the city an area five thousand cubits wide and twenty-five thousand long, adjacent to the district of the holy section; it shall belong to the whole house of Israel.

7 The prince shall have a section on one side and the other of the holy district and the city's property; and bordering on the holy district and the city's property, extending westward on the west side and eastward on the east side, the length shall be side by side with one of the tribal portions, from the west border to the east border.

8 The land shall be his possession in Israel; and My princes shall no more oppress My people, but they shall give the rest of the land to the house of Israel, according to their tribes.

II. Key Summary

- God tells Israel that when they divide the land by lot as an inheritance, they are to set apart a district for the Lord — twenty-five thousand cubits long and ten thousand wide — holy throughout its territory all around.
 - Inside that holy section is a square plot of five hundred by five hundred for the sanctuary, with fifty cubits of open space around it; the section belongs to the priests who minister at the sanctuary, and another area belongs to the Levites who serve at the temple.
 - The property of the city belongs to the whole house of Israel, and the prince's land lies on both sides of the holy district and the city's property; God says His princes shall no more oppress His people, but shall give the rest of the land to Israel according to their tribes.
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III. Passage Analysis

The portion measured out first

It is a holy portion of the land, which is to be set out first, as the first-fruits that sanctify the lump. [1]

When the land is divided, the Lord's portion is the first one measured, and everything else is laid out in relation to it. The priests, the Levites, the city, and the tribes all take their places around the sanctuary.

The prince gets a portion of his own

Former kings of Israel had no domain given them, and this had tempted them to acquire private property by violence and extortion. [2]

In this new arrangement God marks out land for the prince first, and then says, "My princes shall no more oppress My people." Power with a boundary around it stops reaching for someone else's share.

IV. Reflection Question

What actually comes first in your life right now — not what you wish came first, but what really does?

When Israel divided the land, the first portion was measured out for God; and the whole land had been given to them by God to begin with.

References

[1] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry Commentary,
https://www.blueletterbible.org/Comm/mhc/Eze/Eze_045.cfm

[2] BibleHub, Ellicott's Commentary for English Readers,
<https://biblehub.com/commentaries/ezekiel/45-8.htm>